

027. Chapter 3 Verses 1-3

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ।
तत्किं कर्मणि घोरे मां नियोजयसि केशव ॥ १ ॥

arjuna uvācha

jyāyasī chet karmaṇas te matā buddhir janārdana

tat kiṁ karmaṇi ghore māṁ niyojayasi keśhava

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **jyāyasī**—superior; **chet**—if; **karmaṇaḥ**—than fruitive action; **te**—by you; **matā**—is considered; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **janārdana**—he who looks after the public, Krishna; **tat**—then; **kim**—why; **karmaṇi**—action; **ghore**—terrible; **mām**—me; **niyojayasi**—do you engage; **keśhava**—Krishna, the killer of the demon named Keshi;

Arjuna said: O Krishna! If your belief is that knowledge is superior to action, then why do you engage me in this dreadful act of battle?

VERSE 3.2

व्यामिश्रेणेव वाक्येन बुद्धिं मोहयसीव मे ।
तदेकं वद निश्चित्य येन श्रेयोऽहमाप्नुयाम् ॥ २ ॥

vyāmiśhreṇeva vākyena buddhiṁ mohayasīva me

tad ekaṁ vada niśhchitya yena śhreyo 'ham āpnuyām

vyāmiśhreṇa iva—by your apparently ambiguous; **vākyena**—words; **buddhim**—intellect; **mohayasi**—I am getting bewildered; **iva**—as it were; **me**—my; **tat**—therefore; **ekam**—one; **vada**—please tell; **niśhchitya**—decisively; **yena**—by which; **śhreyaḥ**—the highest good; **aham**—I; **āpnuyām**—may attain

With these apparently contradictory words, You seem to confuse my understanding. Therefore tell me definitely that one thing by which I shall reach the Highest Goal.

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

लोकेऽस्मिन्द्विविधा निष्ठा पुरा प्रोक्ता मयानघ ।

ज्ञानयोगेन साङ्ख्यानां कर्मयोगेन योगिनाम् ॥३॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

loke 'smin dvi-vidhā niṣṭhā purā proktā mayānagha

jñāna-yogena sāṅkhyānām karma-yogena yoginām

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Blessed Lord said; **loke**—in the world; **asmin**—this; **dvi-vidhā**—two kinds of; **niṣṭhā**—faith; **purā**—previously; **proktā**—explained; **mayā**—by me (Shree Krishna); **anagha**—sinless; **jñāna-yogena**—through the path of knowledge; **sāṅkhyānām**—for those inclined toward contemplation; **karma-yogena**—through the path of action; **yoginām**—of the yogis

The Blessed Lord said: O sinless Arjuna! In ancient times two paths of spiritual description were spoken by me – the Jnana yoga for the followers of the path of knowledge, and Karma yoga for the followers of the path of action.